

Outlook

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Follow-up: are failed ATM attempts forming an attack sequence?

Hi,

This came up in a working session and nobody had the same definition.

Cyber wants to know whether repeated PIN failures, balance enquiries and cash attempts form recognisable sequences before a card is blocked.

I do not want a dashboard that simply counts the outcome. Start with the competing explanations: normal forgotten-PIN behaviour dominates; specific terminals see repeated card testing; or a balance enquiry followed by rapid withdrawals marks higher risk.

The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure. This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use August 2021 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion.

What we need to decide is which sequences should become monitoring rules and which would create unacceptable false positives. Please bring a control view with the exceptions, owner and reason each item was included, including a few cases we can trace from source to conclusion.

The available evidence is ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories. There is no CCTV, device fingerprint or complete card-network feed, so classify behavioural patterns rather than confirmed attacks.

Thank you